

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 4 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ J 8 3
♣ K 4

♠ A K 3

♥ K 4

♦ A K 6 5

♣ J 8 7 2



♠ J 8 6

♥ Q J 8 7 2

♦ 10 9 4

♣ 6 3

♠ Q 10 7

♥ 10 5

♦ Q 7 2

♣ A Q 10 9 5

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

you know that if you lose the lead there will be a deluge of ♥s on the table. ♣s is your best suit, and if the finesse works you will make 6. Of course if it fails you will go down. But there is one thing you should do before you stake everything on a 50% finesse. You should play 3 rounds of ♦s. If they split 3-3 you will have found your ninth trick and you won't risk the ♣ finesse.

If you try the ♣ finesse you will go down, losing 1 ♣ and 4 ♥s. If you take your 4 ♦ tricks and refuse to try the ♣ finesse you will make the contract.

The best thing about this plan is that when you test the ♦s, if it turns out they do not split 3-3 you can still try the ♣ finesse.

You are too strong to open 1NT. With two 4-card minors the correct opening bid is 1♦. Partner responds 2♣.

You now need to make a jump bid. You **MIGHT** jump to 4♣ but that would bypass what is probably your best game. Instead you just jump to 3NT. Partner doesn't **HAVE** to pass, but he does.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥7 West wins ♥A and returns ♥9.

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Winner count: ♠ 3 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 8

You have a **LOT** of points - but only 8 tricks. And

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 5 3

♥ A 6 4 2

♦ K 7

♣ A K 5

♠ K

♥ J 9 8 3

♦ Q 9 5 4 3

♣ 6 4 2



♠ 10 7 6 2

♥ 5

♦ A 6

♣ Q J 10 8 7 3

♠ Q J 9 4

♥ K Q 10 7

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ 9

West

1 ♣

3 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

pull trumps. You win the ♥ A and play the ♠ A. North plays the ♠ K!

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

4 ♠

South

Pass

Well, you're pretty sure you have a ♣ fit. But before you show partner your fine ♣ support you have an obligation to show a 4-card Major.

You respond 1 ♠, partner jumps to 3 ♠.

Your hand revalues to 11 or 12 points so you should bid game. 5 ♣ requires 11 tricks and 4 ♠ only 10 tricks. You bid 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ K.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2

You expect trumps to split 3-2 so you would lose 2 trumps. You have no other losers so you decide to

Do you change your Plan? Click?

Do you change your **PLAN**?

Well, North may be false-carding. He may also have the ♠ Q for example. But if you decide to play another trump and it turns out he was NOT false-carding you will be dead in the water. South will take his three trump tricks and some ♥ s. Many ♥ s.

So don't take the chance. Abandon trumps and start playing ♣ winners. Let South take the three trumps whenever he wants to. You will not lose control of the hand and will make your 10 tricks.

The risk of leading a second trump was too great.

As you see, South would have pulled your and dummy's trumps and then won 3 ♥ tricks.

A slightly different Plan would also have worked. At trick two you could have played a low trump from both hands. North would win the ♠ K, then probably play another ♥. You ruff, play a ♠ to the ♠ A and discover the split. From there the Plan is the same, play your ♣ s and let South ruff when he wants.